

12TH HSC ENGLISH

MAHARASHTRA BOARD

ALL WRITING SKILLS

- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------------|
| A. Virtual Messages | I. Compering |
| B. Statement of Purpose | J. Blog Writing |
| C. Group Discussion | K. Speech Writing |
| D. Email Writing | L. Summary Writing |
| E. Report Writing | Expansion of Ideas |
| F. Mind Mapping | Book Review |
| G. Appeal Writing | Film Review |
| H. Interview Questions | |

A. **Virtual Messages**

Virtual messages are brief and concise messages used for digital communication, primarily sent via emails, messaging apps, or social media platforms. They focus on clarity and professionalism, especially when addressing formal or semi-formal contexts.

Purpose of Virtual Messages

1. Convey information quickly and effectively.
 2. Maintain a record of communication.
 3. Adapt to various communication contexts (formal, informal, semi-formal).
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Format of Virtual Messages

1. **Date & Time (Format is specified below)**
 2. **Salutation/Greeting:**
 - Start with an appropriate salutation.
 - Examples:
 - **Formal:** *Dear Sir/Madam, Respected [Name], Greetings!*
 - **Informal:** *Hi [Name], Hello [Name], Hey!*
 3. **Body:**
 - **Purpose:** State the reason for the message clearly in the first line.
 - **Details:** Include the necessary details to make your message clear and actionable.
 - **Tone:**
 - Formal for official or professional settings.
 - Friendly for casual communication.
 4. **Closing:**
 - Use polite expressions or calls to action.
 - Examples: *Looking forward to your reply. Please let me know if you need further assistance.*
 5. **Sign-Off:**
 - End with your name and, if required, a designation or contact information.
 - Examples: *Thanks, Best regards, Warm wishes.*
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Examples of Virtual Messages

1. Formal Virtual Message

Scenario: You are informing your teacher about being absent due to a health issue.

Message:

10th February, 2025 11:00 am

Respected Sir,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to inform you that I am feeling unwell and will not be able to attend school for the next two days, i.e., **15th and 16th December 2024**. I assure you that I will complete all the missed assignments upon my return. Thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,
[Your Name]

2. Semi-Formal Virtual Message

Scenario: You are coordinating with a team member about an upcoming event.

Message:

10th February, 2025 11:00 am

Mr Rahul,

I hope you're doing well. This is a reminder about the **team meeting** scheduled for tomorrow at **10:00 AM** to discuss the upcoming **cultural event preparations**. Please make sure to carry the budget proposal and the activity list. Looking forward to your confirmation.

Best Regards,
Priya

3. Informal Virtual Message

Scenario: You are inviting your friend to a get-together.

Message:

10th February, 2025 11:00 am

Hey Sam!

Hope all is good with you. We're planning a small **get-together** at my place this Saturday evening at 7 PM. It would be awesome if you could join us. Let me know if you can make it!

Cheers,
Rohan

B. Statement of Purpose

A **Statement of Purpose (SOP)** is an important document that expresses your intentions, goals, and motivations for applying to a particular academic program or job. It is often required for university applications, internships, and scholarships. Writing a clear, concise, and convincing SOP is crucial in the HSC exams, as it demonstrates both writing and **self-reflection** skills.

Format:

1. Introduction:

- Introduce yourself and state the **program** or **course** you're applying for.
- Mention the **university** or institution you're applying to.
- Provide a brief explanation of why you are interested in the program.

2. Academic Background:

- Discuss your **educational background** and how it aligns with the course you're applying for.
- Highlight relevant skills, subjects, or projects that prepare you for the program.

3. Why This Program:

- Explain why you have chosen this specific program and **institution**.
- Discuss the skills you aim to develop and how they align with your career goals.

4. Career Goals:

- Share your **future career aspirations** and how this program will help you achieve them.

5. Conclusion:

- Conclude with your enthusiasm for the program.
- Reinforce your commitment and why you're a suitable candidate.

Sample Statement of Purpose:

I am writing to apply for the **Bachelor of Computer Science** program at XYZ University. My passion for technology and problem-solving began during my high school years when basic coding was introduced to me. Over the years, I have strengthened my foundation in computer science through projects and self-learning.

During my time in high school, I participated in a number of **coding competitions**, and developed skills in algorithmic thinking and **programming languages** like Python and C++. This exposure fueled my interest in **artificial intelligence** and since then, the focus lies on projects related to **machine learning** and **data analysis**.

XYZ University is my top choice due to its **cutting-edge research** in **AI** and its comprehensive curriculum that will help me further my understanding of computer systems.

I am confident that the knowledge ought to be gained will allow me to pursue a career as a **software developer**, and later as a **data scientist**, contributing to the technological advancements in the field of artificial intelligence.

In conclusion, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to and grow within XYZ University's **dynamic** academic environment.

C. **Group Discussion**

A **Group Discussion (GD)** is an exercise where multiple participants discuss a specific topic in a structured setting. It is often used in interviews and assessments to evaluate communication, leadership, and critical thinking skills. HSC exams may include GD-based questions where you need to evaluate your **response** and **engagement** during a discussion.

Format:

1. **Introduction:**

- Briefly introduce yourself and state your **position** on the topic. You can provide a **short context** of why the topic is relevant.

2. **Body:**

- **Argument Presentation:** Present your arguments logically with supporting evidence, examples, or facts.
- **Engagement:** If others contribute, listen actively and build on their points. Use polite phrases to agree, disagree, or add new ideas. For instance, "I agree with [Name]'s point on..." or "However, I believe [another viewpoint] ..."

3. **Conclusion:**

- **Summarize** the key points discussed.
- If necessary, **suggest** a solution or **conclude** with your perspective on the matter.

Sample Group Discussion:

Topic: "Should the government provide free internet to all citizens?"

Introduction:

Good morning, everyone. The topic we are discussing today is whether the **government** should provide **free internet** to all citizens. I believe that access to the internet should be a basic **right** in today's digital world, and free internet will open doors for **education**, **employment**, and overall **social development**.

Body:

- The internet is a powerful tool for **education**. With the **pandemic** forcing many students to switch to **online learning**, free internet would ensure that every student, regardless of their financial background, has equal access to **learning resources**.
- Free internet also boosts **job opportunities**. Many job applications, interviews, and work-from-home options are now conducted online. Free access could empower **unemployed** individuals to apply for jobs.
- However, some might argue that the government may face challenges in providing **uninterrupted service** or maintaining **quality**. It is important that we ensure **effective infrastructure** is in place before this initiative is rolled out.

Conclusion:

In conclusion, I believe that providing free internet is a step toward building an **inclusive society**. While there are logistical challenges, the **long-term benefits** of a more connected and educated population make it a worthy cause. If implemented properly, it could bridge the **digital divide** and open up new possibilities for the **economy** and **education**.

D. Email Writing

Email writing is an essential skill for effective communication, particularly in the professional and academic world. It's an integral part of the HSC exam, where you may need to draft formal or informal emails.

Email Writing Format

From:

(Your Email Address)

To:

(Recipient's Email Address)

CC:

(Email addresses of people to be copied, if any)

Subject:

(A concise statement about the email's purpose)

Date:

(Current Date)

Time:

(Current Time)

Salutation:

(Dear [Name], Respected [Name], or Hello [Name])

Content:

1. First Paragraph (Introduction):

- Briefly state the purpose of the email.
- Provide necessary context or background information.

2. Second Paragraph (Details):

- Elaborate on the purpose of the email.
- Include relevant details, data, or requests.

3. Third Paragraph (Closing/Call to Action):

- Mention any actions required, next steps, or requests for a response.
- End on a positive note, expressing gratitude or looking forward to a reply.

Closing Line:

- Mention if any **attachments** are included.

Example: *Please find the attached documents for your reference.*

Thank You,

Regards,

(Your Name)

(Your Residence/Office Address)

(Your Phone Number)

Signature Line (if applicable):

[Your Designation]

[Company/Institution Name]

***SAMPLE EMAIL is provided on the next page for your reference**

Sample Email

From:

aryan.sharma@gmail.com

To:

principal.collegename@gmail.com

CC:

hod.englishdept@gmail.com

Subject:

Request for Leave Due to Personal Reasons

Date:

16th December 2024

Time:

11:00 AM

Dear Principal,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to formally request leave for **two days**, i.e., **17th and 18th December 2024**, as I need to attend to urgent personal matters. This leave is essential for me to address certain family responsibilities that cannot be postponed.

During this period, I will ensure all my academic tasks and assignments are completed on time. I have already coordinated with my classmates to gather the notes and updates for the lectures I will miss. I assure you that my absence will not affect my academic performance.

I kindly request you to approve my leave. Please find the **attached leave application form** for your reference, as per the college policy. Let me know if any further documentation is required.

Closing Line:

Thank you for your time and understanding. I look forward to your approval.

Thank You,

Regards,

Flat No. 5, Green Park Apartments, Mumbai
9876543210

Signature Line:

[Student, FYJC Commerce]
[ABC College, Mumbai]

E. Report Writing

Report writing is often included in the HSC exams, focusing on the ability to present information in a **structured**, **factual**, and **concise** manner. It's essential to follow the correct format while clearly analyzing the data or situation presented.

Format:

1. **Title Page:** Includes the **title** of the report, your name, the name of the institution, and the date.
2. **Abstract/Executive Summary:** A brief summary (100-150 words) of the report's main points, findings, and recommendations.
3. **Introduction:** Introduce the **purpose** of the report and the **scope** of the content (what will be covered).
4. **Methodology:** Discuss how you gathered the data or information (e.g., **surveys**, **interviews**, **research**).
5. **Findings/Results:** Present the **data** or results, organized clearly. Use bullet points or tables if necessary.
6. **Discussion/Analysis:** Analyze and interpret the findings, drawing conclusions based on the results.
7. **Conclusion:** Provide a **summary** of the findings, highlighting key points and suggesting **recommendations**.
8. **References/Appendices:** Cite sources used for data or research, and include any additional relevant materials.

Sample Report:

Title: Survey on Student Preferences for Online Learning

Abstract:

This report investigates the preferences of students regarding online learning during the COVID-19 pandemic. The findings indicate that while a majority of students prefer online learning for its flexibility, they also face challenges such as **poor internet connectivity** and **lack of face-to-face interaction**. Recommendations include **enhancing digital infrastructure** and **increasing interactive sessions** to improve learning experiences.

Introduction:

The purpose of this report is to understand the attitudes of students towards **online learning** during the COVID-19 pandemic. The scope of the report includes a survey of **500 students** from various academic streams.

Methodology:

The data was collected through an **online survey** conducted between **1st September** and **10th September 2024**. The survey contained questions about students' **preferences**, **challenges**, and their **overall experience** with online learning.

Findings:

- **60%** of students preferred online learning for its **flexibility**.
- **50%** of students faced **technical issues**, including poor internet connectivity.
- **70%** of students reported feeling disconnected from their peers and teachers.

Discussion:

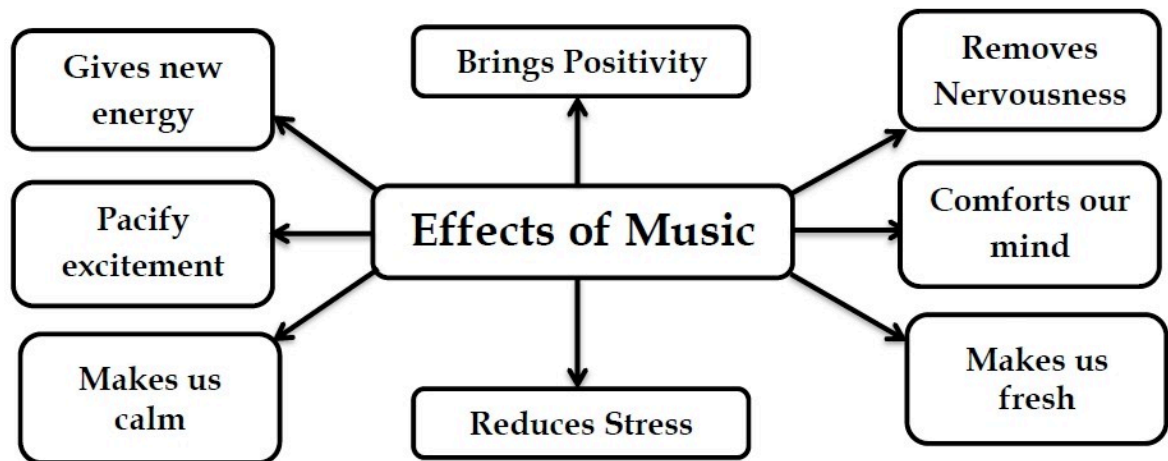
While the majority of students find online learning convenient, the **lack of interaction** and **technical challenges** hinder its effectiveness. It is crucial to improve **internet infrastructure** and incorporate more interactive elements like **video conferences** and **virtual study groups**.

Conclusion:

Online learning has the potential to be a highly effective tool, but it needs to be improved. Universities and educational institutions must focus on **improving technical support** and **creating interactive opportunities** for students.

F. MIND MAPPING

Ans: Design 1



G. Appeal Writing

Appeal for avoiding plastic

“Say NO to PLASTIC Bags”

Say **NO** to **Plastic** bags
Carry your own **Cloth** bags

Friends, **Plastic bags** have been creating **havoc** with
Environment and domestic cattle as well as wildlife.

PLASTIC is not easily destroyed and it takes many years to
break down.

Remember,

Plastic is very dangerous to our Environment.

**Plastic product harms our life,
Leave it.. otherwise it would work as knife!**

COME ONE..COME ALL

to

Join this Drive:

at

‘PLASTIC FREE CITY DRIVE’

Devchand College, Arjunnagar

Tal- Kagal, Dist- Kolhapur

Prof.Vinayak M.Kumbhar

H. Interview Questions

NOW, these topics are continued –

- Interview
- Expansion of Ideas
- Blog
- Appeal
- Speech
- Compering
- Summary Writing
- Mind Mapping

I. Compering

Compering

Imagine your college has arranged a special programme '*Tribute to Soldiers' on Kargil din*. As a compere draft a script for the whole function. Maintain proper sequence.

[Welcome, Introduction, Felicitation of soldiers, Special Programme, presidential address, vote of thanks.]

ANSWER

1. Welcome

Good morning one and all. Respected principal. teachers, guests, and dear friends!

Today, we have gathered for a special programme, *Tribute to Soldiers*, to honour the brave heroes of our country. Today, on *Kargil Day*, we remember the soldiers who fought for our safety. Let us welcome everyone to this event with a big round of applause!

2. Introduction

Our soldiers are our real heroes. They guard our country day and night. They keep us safe so we can live in peace. Today, we are here to thank them and to show our respect. Let us give them our heartfelt gratitude!

3. Felicitation of Soldiers

Now, we would like to honour the soldiers present with us today. May we kindly invite our principal to present them with tokens of respect. Dear soldiers, please accept our small tribute for your big courage!

4. Special Programme

To celebrate and honour our heroes, we now have a special program to show our respect for our soldiers. Students of XII class will present a dance and a patriotic song to say "Thank you" to our heroes.

Please enjoy the program and cheer for them!

5. Presidential Address

Now, we invite our principal, to speak a few words.

Thank you, Principal Sir.

6. Vote of Thanks

Now, it is time to say "Thank you" to everyone.

We thank our soldiers for coming today and everyone who helped to make this program a success.

Thank you to our teachers, students, and everyone who joined us today.

J. **BLOG** (Any 1 format as below works) 1.

EARTH CARE

A blog meant for the Environment Care

Eco-Friendly Festival: Need of Time

ARCHIVES

APRIL (15)

MARCH (20)

FEBRUARY (25)

JANUARY (12)

SUBSCRIBE TO
BLOG VIA
EMAIL

SUBSCRIBE

Blog
Stats

1852255
hits

An eco-friendly festival is a celebration that protects nature. For example, we can use natural decorations like flowers, leaves, and clay. Instead of plastic plates and cups, we can use reusable or biodegradable items. This helps reduce plastic waste. Festivals bring joy, but they can also harm nature. Many festivals create a lot of waste and pollution. Fireworks, plastic decorations, and loud sounds can hurt our environment. That's why we need to celebrate in eco-friendly ways.

Fireworks are beautiful, but they cause air pollution and harm animals. Instead, we can enjoy lights, lanterns, and eco-friendly decorations. Planting a tree during a festival is another great idea—it brings beauty and fresh air. Even small changes can make a big difference. We can ask our friends and family to join us in making festivals eco-friendly. This way, we still enjoy our traditions and keep the Earth clean and safe.

Celebrating eco-friendly festivals shows that we care about our planet. When we protect nature, we protect our future. So, let us all choose eco-friendly ways to celebrate. Together, we can make our festivals fun and safe for everyone, including the Earth!

COMMENTS

DISCLAIMER POLICY

HOME

2.

Examples of a blog post

- Menu Share Elysian for junior college	About the writer Mr. Tushar Bagwe
Child Labour – a curse to humanity The term, 'Child Labour' itself makes me shudder. Childhood is a time to be enjoyed, to have fun and play games; not to labour. But the unfortunate fact is that children in India, and in many other countries too, are made to do the worst forms of labour. In India, lakhs of poor children are forced to work, baking bricks, making fireworks, weaving carpets, rolling beedis, picking rags, working as domestic servants, waiters, etc. and this is just the tip of the iceberg. Children are also sexually exploited or made to work as beggars. Things are worse now with terrorist camps apparently recruiting children for training. While we condemn child labour, we also know the cause of this malady. It is due to poverty. The natural disasters, family debts, and the like. Well then, what can we, as concerned citizens, do to prevent this? In addition to talking and writing about it ? First of all, we can boycott those goods made by using child labour, high on this being fireworks. We can complain to authorities when we see a child being forced to work. We can report beggars; we can contribute or volunteer to work for NGOs. However, the most sure-fire method of eradicating this problem is through education. Education is the only single solution, and through education many of the ills bogging down our nation can be cured. So, those who see a child employed somewhere, please raise your voice. Child labour is certainly a curse to humanity.	Comments Recent posts - - - Follow us on     
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K. **Speech Writing**

Speech Writing - Example

Your college has organized an elocution competition on World Blind Day. Prepare a speech stating the importance of eye donation to be given before the college students.

Ans -

Respected Principal, teachers & my dear friends,
Today on the occasion of World Blind Day, I am here to speak a few words on the topic- importance of eye donation. Eminent English poet Sylvia Plath, in one of her poems says -

*'I shut my eyes and all the world drops dead;
I lift my eyes and all is born again.'*

Eyes! It is one of the most wonderful gift God has given to us. We are able to see this beautiful world, colourful things, delightful people, only because of our eyes. Just imagine, how we feel when the electricity goes down at night? We are scared of not able to see anything. We stumble at places. The blind people have to live with the same feeling throughout their lives. Don't you know that we are able to give them a helping hand? I and you and we all, can do a small thing and bring a ray of light in their lives. Yes! By donating our eyes, we can help the blind to see this colourful, beautiful, wonderful world. For this, we have to pledge our eyes.

Almost anyone can donate their corneas. Take a note that, your corneas could be invaluable for saving someone's sight, to give someone a sight. People can donate

their corneas when they die. Remember that there is no age restriction for donating eyes. What you have to do exactly? Let me explain, Tell your friends and family that you want to be a cornea donor – it is very important that they understand and support your decision because your family's support is needed for donation to go ahead. Note that corneas can be donated up to 24 hours after death.

By donating our eyes, we can make our eyes immortal. After our death, our eyes will continue to exist in this world. Isn't it a wonderful thing? I strongly feel that eye donation is really a worthy donation. I remember what Sir Kristian Goldmund Aumann has said –

*“If your eyes dwell in your heart;
then your inner voice will be your congenial Guide.”*

Friends, I wish, your inner voice guide you rightfully in this matter. May you all understand the need of time and resolve to donate your eyes. If the recipient of your eyes continues this cycle of eye donation forward, your eyes will be fortunate to see this world forever. With lots of hope and positivity, and expecting a kind gesture from you, I would stop here. A big thank you to everybody for quietly listening to me.

L. Summary Writing

Summary Writing Format

1. **Title:** Mention the title of the passage or text you are summarizing.
 2. **Introduction:** Briefly state the main theme or idea of the passage.
 3. **Body:** Summarize the important points from the passage, keeping it concise and focusing on the key ideas.
 - Avoid unnecessary details or repetition.
 - Exclude examples, illustrations, or minor points unless they are crucial to the main idea.
 4. **Conclusion:** End with a statement that reflects the overall purpose or takeaway of the passage.
-

Sample Question

Read the following passage and write a summary:

Passage:

Time is one of the most precious resources available to humans. It cannot be stored, paused, or extended, making it essential to use time wisely. Successful people understand the importance of managing time efficiently. Procrastination, the act of delaying tasks, is one of the biggest obstacles to effective time management. Overcoming procrastination requires discipline and proper planning. Prioritizing tasks based on urgency and importance helps individuals make the most of their time. Additionally, setting realistic goals and avoiding distractions, such as social media, can improve productivity. Therefore, making the best use of time is crucial for personal and professional growth.

Sample Summary

Title: The Importance of Time Management

Summary:

Time is a valuable resource that cannot be stored or extended, making its effective management essential. Procrastination is a major barrier to utilizing time efficiently and can be overcome through discipline and planning. Prioritizing tasks based on their urgency, setting realistic goals, and avoiding distractions such as social media are key to improving productivity. Effective time management plays a vital role in achieving personal and professional success.

Tips for Writing a Good Summary

1. **Identify the Key Points:** Focus on the most important ideas and ignore less relevant details.
2. **Use Your Own Words:** Avoid directly copying sentences from the passage. Rephrase the content in a concise manner.
3. **Maintain Neutrality:** Do not include personal opinions or interpretations.
4. **Keep it Concise:** The summary should be about **one-third** the length of the original passage.

Expansion of Ideas

1] A FRIEND IN NEED IS A FRIEND INDEED

Once it was raining very heavily. It didn't seem that it would stop. There was no means of transport and I wondered how I would reach home. Then as if from nowhere, a classmate happened by in a car. He asked me to get in and reached me to my home. From that day onwards he became one of my best friends. Later on I was able to help him out in mathematics, a subject in which he was very weak. Indeed, a friend in need is a friend indeed!

I have found that many people talk about friendship, but when you need them during the time of crisis, somehow they are not be seen anywhere. Those who stand by you when you are really in trouble are your true friends. Isn't that what friends are for? To help each other in times of need?

Life is all about being there for others. Life is all about caring and sharing. There are plenty of fair-weather friends. They desert you in your time of need. True friends are steadfast. True friends are forever.

2] A Little Learning is a Dangerous Thing.

We have heard of 'quacks' in the villages who try to cure serious diseases by their so called magical remedies. This is an example of a little learning being a dangerous thing. Finally when the patient dies they shift the blame to some supernatural powers and wash their hands of the tragedy.

Sometimes children try to imitate dangerous scenes from films, little realizing the harm that they can cause to themselves or others. Likewise, learning Yoga from someone who is not an expert in the art could be dangerous. Some people try to repair domestic appliances on their own thinking they can do the job themselves. Lacking sufficient knowledge, they only spoil the appliance. They would do well to call a technician to do the job.

Listening to the advice of someone who is less educated than you can result in your making wrong choices in life. Remember Lord Buddha's teaching: Travel not with a fool. He further goes on to say that if the people you are travelling with are less clever than you or equal in cleverness to you, it is better to travel alone. In other words, it is better to have no friends than to have one who has little knowledge.

3] All That Glitters is not Gold

Everything in life that appears to be attractive does not necessarily have great value. So judging by appearances can be misleading. This same fact can be said in another way: A book cannot be judged by its cover, A book with a very attractive cover may not have readable material inside. On the other hand, a book with a very dull cover may be very interesting. This is true of almost everything in life. A show that is well advertised may be dull and boring. And a movie that has received very little publicity may be quite entertaining.

So we must not jump to conclusions about the merits or demerits of anything purely on the basis of the way it is packaged. This is the age of advertisement. Makers of products try to show their products in the best light so that people will buy them. But this does not necessarily mean that the product is well worth the money. Even when we judge people we should not do so by their looks. We must not get swayed by their flashy styles or dashing ways. Gandhiji wore just a dhoti, but he is still held in great reverence throughout the world. Abraham Lincoln was not endowed with good looks. But he is considered by far the greatest American President. Mother Teresa had a very simple appearance. But people all over the world remember and revere her. So it is only fair to say that all that glitters is not gold.

4] An Apple a day keeps the Doctor away.

What is special about the fruit, the apple? Why is it said that the apple keeps the doctor away? Why is no other fruit mentioned in a proverb? The answers are very simple. the apple has the most nutritional value amongst all fruits.

A medium sized apple gives 80 calories and makes a good snack. It contains absolutely no fat. It also helps reduce the risk of some cancers. Because it is low in sodium content, it reduces the risk of high blood pressure and heart disease. The apple has a substance that can reduce bad cholesterol and increase good cholesterol in our body. It is also rich in Vitamin A, which strengthens our vision. Apple also contain Vitamin C that boosts the immune system in the body. Research shows that people who eat five apples or more per week have fewer respiratory problems, including asthma.

After eating any kind of food, eat an apple. An apple is a natural toothbrush. It prevents tooth decay by killing 80% of the bacteria in the teeth. Thus, this proverb reminds us of the role of diet in warding off diseases - and how it saves us the trouble of visiting the doctor.

5] As You Sow, So Shall You Reap

If farmers desires to reap a harvest of wheat, he sows wheat; if he wants rice, he sows rice. What should we think of him if he planted wheat and expected to harvest rice; or the other way round? The law of nature tells us that we must sow what we wish to reap. If we sow nothing, we shall reap nothing.

So it is with life. We always have to bear the consequences of our actions. If we perform good deeds, we shall be rewarded with good. If we perform bad deeds, we shall never enjoy peace of mind. Our lives will be wretched and miserable. We cannot achieve fair ends by using foul means. Even if we do, it will be short - lived.

Man can decide his own future by his present deeds. If he sows the seeds of vice, corruption and sin, he reaps the harvest of misery and ruin. If he

plants virtue, purity and goodness, he plucks the golden fruit of success and happiness. If we want to achieve good, we should do good, for as we sow, so shall we reap.

6]Books - our Best Friends

Good books enrich the mind by providing knowledge. They also widen the horizons of our imaginations, and give us an insight into different minds. If a man is known by the company he keeps, why should we not, then, keep the best company, that of good books? Good literature entertains, instructs and elevates. It takes us on a flight of fancy, away from our humdrum lives, to a place or country we want to visit, without having to pay for the passage.

Pleasures derived from eating or playing sports are short lived and ordinary, but the pleasure that we derive from reading books is everlasting and fantastic. Even after we have finished reading a book, we continue to think about it and derive pleasure from it.

To derive maximum pleasure from reading we have to gradually pass on from comics, detective novels, magazines and simple storybooks to classic literature. Just like friends, the quality of the books that we read also determine the kind of person we are. Good books will enrich our personalities, and it is these kinds of books that we should turn to when we have the leisure.

7]Charity begins at Home.

It is very easy to show the whole world that you are doing good deeds. Many people do this just to impress others. But when it comes to treating well the people who are near them, they are sadly lacking. They treat their children, family members, servants and people who are closely connected with them very badly.

If you really want to be good to others, it has to spread to all walks of life, and should begin with your home. As we treat others who are close to us, so should we treat those who are not so close to us. Treating others well should be a habit with us. It should not be an attitude that we display only to gain name or fame. It should be the same when treating the smallest and the closest as well as treating the greatest and the farthest.

8] Cleanliness is next to Godliness

An unclean environment is an insult to the Creator. Everything that God has created is beautiful, and Mother Nature in her power and means to maintain the hygiene and sanitation of the earth. It is only man who makes the environment dirty. For reasons best known to himself, very often, man is happy to keep it that way.

When you go to a place of religious worship, don't you bathe first? Don't you put on your best clothes? Remember, this world is our temple and the first norm we must follow is that of personal hygiene. This involves keeping one's body, clothes, belongings and home clean. This prevents diseases and enhances the quality of life. It also keeps the mind fresh and motivated us to work better.

Cleanliness must also extend towards the neighbourhood and the environment in general. For this, it is imperative that every person develops clean social and civic habits. It is wrong to spit on the roads, urinate in

public or throw litter anywhere one pleases. Doing such things only spoil this wonderful place that has been gifted to us by the Almighty - our planet Earth.

It is our moral duty to keep ourselves, our homes, our environment, our nation and this earth clean. That is what is meant by the proverb 'Cleanliness is next to Godliness'.

9] Experience is the best teacher

If you warn a child not to put his or her hand near the fire, he or she may not listen to you. But if the child actually touches the flame out of curiosity, he or she will get burnt. By actual experience the child will learn that putting one's hand in fire can cause a lot of pain and physical damage.

Most of our study is based on books. We may read a lot about the beauty of the Taj Mahal, but actually making a visit to the Taj, we will really experience its grandeur. Again, there are many skills, like mechanical skills, for which more theoretical knowledge is not sufficient. We must actually go through the experience of handling the machines and learning from our mistakes.

Even our judgements about people or things are based on our past experiences. Thus, we can conclude that experience is the best teacher, and one should not shy away from the various experiences life has to offer.

10]Is Plastic Bad for the Environment?

Plastic is extremely bad for the environment. It is one of man's worst inventions. Plastic is non-biodegradable. This means that waste plastic cannot be turned into any other substance that is eco-friendly. Although tonnes and tonnes of plastic are burnt in the most advanced incinerators, all that remains is plastic. It doesn't change into anything else, as many other materials do. Hence, plastic waste is dangerous to the environment.

Plastic carry bags reach the drainage system and this causes clogging especially during the rains. If too much plastic ends up in a lake or a pond, it creates a layer that denies oxygen to everything below so that no plant or animal life can survive in that water body. If animals eat plastic bags thrown in rubbish dumps, it knots up their intestines and they die painful deaths. If plastic lies on land it can choke it to the extent that nothing will grow there again. Hence, plastic must be done away with completely.

There are many alternatives to plastic and we should use them. For shopping we can use cloth, jute or paper carry bags. We can get milk in bottles or cartons. We can use metal or glass jars instead of plastic ones. Many things now made of plastic can have better and eco-friendly alternatives. So the earlier we say goodbye to the plastic the safer the future of the planet Earth.



Book Review

A **Book Review** is a critical summary of a book's content, themes, characters, and overall impact. In the HSC exam, it should follow a **structured format**, focusing on clarity and a well-rounded opinion.

Format:

1. Introduction:

- Mention the **title** of the book, the **author**, and any relevant background information about the book (e.g., genre, target audience, and year of publication).
- Provide a brief **overview** of what the book is about.

2. Body:

- **Summary of the Plot:** Briefly explain the **main storyline** or **plot**. Don't give away spoilers, but provide enough details to set the context.
- **Characters:** Describe the **main characters**, their development throughout the book, and how they contribute to the story. Mention their **strengths**, **flaws**, and any **significant transformations**.
- **Themes:** Identify the **major themes** of the book. These could include topics such as **love**, **friendship**, **betrayal**, **identity**, etc. Discuss how the author conveys these themes through the narrative.
- **Writing Style:** Comment on the **author's writing style**. Is it simple or complex? Does the style enhance the story, or does it hinder understanding? Are there any unique features in the narrative?
- **Pacing:** Discuss whether the book flows at a **steady pace** or if it has sections that feel **too fast** or **too slow**.

3. Conclusion:

- Provide your **overall opinion** of the book. Was it **engaging**, **thought-provoking**, or **predictable**? Would you recommend it to others? Why or why not?
- Mention the **target audience** for the book. Who would benefit from reading it?

Sample Book Review:

Title: *The Great Gatsby*

Author: F. Scott Fitzgerald

Genre: Classic Fiction, Tragedy

Year of Publication: 1925

Introduction:

The Great Gatsby is one of the most significant American novels, written by F. Scott Fitzgerald. Set in the **Roaring Twenties**, the book explores themes of **wealth**, **love**, **dreams**, and **disillusionment** through the life of its protagonist, **Jay Gatsby**, and his mysterious life.

Summary of Plot:

The story is narrated by **Nick Carraway**, a young man who moves to New York and befriends his wealthy neighbor, **Jay Gatsby**. Gatsby is a mysterious figure known for his extravagant parties and obsession with his lost love, **Daisy Buchanan**. As the story unfolds, Nick uncovers Gatsby's tragic past and his obsession with recreating the past with Daisy.

The novel ends in tragedy, with Gatsby's dream of rekindling his relationship with Daisy shattering.

Characters:

- **Jay Gatsby** is portrayed as the ultimate tragic hero, a man who accumulates wealth in the hope of winning back his lost love. His **idealism** and obsession with the past ultimately lead to his downfall.
- **Nick Carraway**, the narrator, offers an outsider's perspective on the events of the novel. He is morally neutral but deeply affected by the events surrounding Gatsby.
- **Daisy Buchanan** symbolizes the unattainable **American Dream** and the superficiality of wealth.

Themes:

- The book touches on **class disparity** and the notion that wealth does not lead to **happiness** or **fulfillment**. Gatsby's dreams are ultimately crushed by the immorality and indifference of the world he longs to be part of.
- The theme of **illusion versus reality** is central, as Gatsby's life is built on a **false reality**, a dream that he is trying to make true.

Writing Style:

Fitzgerald's writing style is poetic and reflective, often using imagery and symbols, such as the **green light** at Daisy's dock, which represents Gatsby's **dream**. The language is symbolic, reflecting the deeper meanings of the story.

Conclusion:

The Great Gatsby is an enduring classic that explores the consequences of chasing unattainable dreams. Fitzgerald's exploration of the **American Dream** is both tragic and poignant. I would recommend this book to anyone interested in exploring themes of **ambition**, **wealth**, and **disillusionment**. It's a novel that challenges the notion of the **American Dream** and remains relevant to this day.

Film Review

A **Film Review** requires you to analyze the movie's plot, direction, acting, and themes. In the HSC exam, the review must be structured clearly, focusing on the **technical aspects** and your **personal critique**.

Format:

1. Introduction:

- Mention the **title** of the film, the **director**, the **release year**, and the **main cast**.
- Provide a brief **overview** of the plot without revealing any spoilers.

2. Body:

- **Plot:** Discuss the **central plot** of the movie. Provide an overview of the **main conflict** and **resolution**.
- **Direction and Cinematography:** Comment on the director's ability to bring the story to life. Was the direction **innovative** or **predictable**? Discuss the **cinematography** and how it contributes to the atmosphere or theme.
- **Acting:** Evaluate the performance of the **actors**. Were the characters believable? Did they bring depth to their roles?
- **Music and Sound:** Discuss how the **soundtrack** and **sound effects** contributed to the movie's tone.
- **Themes and Messages:** Identify the major themes of the film. Does the film provide a **social commentary** or **moral lesson**?

3. Conclusion:

- Provide your **opinion** on the film. Was it **entertaining**, **emotionally moving**, or **boring**? Would you recommend it to others? Why or why not?

Sample Film Review:

Title: *Inception*

Director: Christopher Nolan

Release Year: 2010

Main Cast: Leonardo DiCaprio, Joseph Gordon-Levitt, Ellen Page, Tom Hardy

Introduction:

Inception is a science fiction film directed by Christopher Nolan, which explores the complex world of **dream manipulation**. The film follows **Dom Cobb**, a professional thief who specializes in stealing secrets through the process of **dream sharing**. Cobb is offered a chance to have his criminal record erased if he can successfully plant an idea in someone's mind, a process known as **inception**.

Plot:

Cobb assembles a team to carry out the heist, but the deeper they go into the layers of the dream, the more complicated their mission becomes. The film plays with the concept of **reality versus illusion**, leaving the audience to question what is real and what is a dream. As the story progresses, the stakes get higher, and Cobb faces personal struggles related to his past.

Direction and Cinematography:

Christopher Nolan's direction is brilliant, as he takes the audience through multiple layers of dreams without losing the **narrative coherence**. The **visual effects** in the film are mind-blowing, with memorable sequences like the **bending city** and the **zero-gravity fight** scene. The cinematography by Wally Pfister enhances the dreamlike quality of the film, using wide shots to create an expansive, surreal atmosphere.

Acting:

Leonardo DiCaprio delivers an outstanding performance as Dom Cobb, capturing the emotional depth of a man haunted by his past. The supporting cast, including **Joseph Gordon-Levitt** and **Ellen Page**, adds depth to the story with strong performances. The characters are well-developed, and each actor brings authenticity to their role.

Music and Sound:

The **musical score** by Hans Zimmer is haunting and perfectly complements the film's tension. The famous track, "**Time**", evokes deep emotions, making the scenes more intense. The use of **sound design** also plays a crucial role in enhancing the dream-world atmosphere.

Themes and Messages:

Inception explores the themes of **guilt**, **memory**, and **reality**. The movie asks profound questions about the nature of dreams and how they shape our perceptions of reality.

The central theme revolves around the idea of **personal redemption**, as Cobb seeks to reconcile with his past.

Conclusion:

Inception is a brilliant, mind-bending film that successfully blends **action**, **sci-fi**, and **psychological drama**. It's a film that challenges the audience to think critically and question their own reality. I highly recommend this film to anyone who enjoys **thought-provoking cinema**. With stellar performances and outstanding direction, it is a cinematic masterpiece.